3

TECHNICAL TERMS

3.1 INTRODUCTION

Just like there are numerous things around us and every thing has its own particular name which facilitates its use, all the things used in cutting and tailoring too have their own name. These names have a particular meaning in the trade. Hence, for anyone entering the world of cutting and tailoring, it becomes essential to be familiar with the terminology.

But before we learn the technical terms, let us learn what is the need for having technical terms and also the advantage of using such terms in our work day like.

3.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to do the following:-

- describe technical terms used in cutting and tailoring;
- use these terms in your work.

3.3 WHAT ARE TECHNICAL TERMS ?

Words associated with a particular trade and which have a certain meaning relevant to the trade are called technical terms. These terms are extensively used in that particular trade.

3.4 NEED

1) To accomplish the work easily and conveniently.

2) To save time

3.5 ADVANTAGES

1) These are easily understood

2) It becomes easy to communicate with others.

3.6 SOME TERMS YOU SHOULD KNOW

1. Grain

Lengthwise or crosswise threads of a fabric. The lengthwise grains are called 'weft' and the crosswise grains are called 'warp' or 'woof'.

2. Grainline

The lengthwise threads show the grainline.

3. Bias

A strip of cloth cut at an angle of 45° to the lengthwise and widthwise grain is known as 'bias' or bias strip. It has maximum stretch.

4. Seam

The line of stitching obtained on joining two pieces of fabric is known as a 'seam'.

5. Base line

The line on which drafting begins is known as 'base line'.

6. Facing

Any strip of fabric used to finish an edge is known as 'facing', e.g. in necklines and armholes. Sometimes facings are not turned in but turned out onto the right side of a garment in a decorative manner.

7. Opening

The open parts of a garment made to facilitate putting on and taking off are known as 'openings'.

8. Slit

The side opening in a garment is known as 'slit'. Both the edges of a slit touch each other but do not overlap. Example-slit in coat jackets, slit in kurta in ladies salwar suit.

9. Gathers

When the width of fabric is reduced to desired width by pulling it tight into small ruffles is known as 'gathers'. This may be done by running a wide stitch on the machine or by tacking by hand and then pulling up the thread to from the gathers.

10. Inlays

The extra fabric kept outside the seam line of a garment is known as 'inlays'.

11. Margin

While cutting, the extra fabric kept apart from that needed according to measurement is known as 'margin'. This is usually kept so that the seams can be let out and the garment expanded, if needed, later on.

12. Hem

When the desired length of any garment is to be finished, the extra cloth is folded in and secured with a fine hand stitch known as 'hem'.

13. Laying

The laying out of the cloth before cutting is known as 'laying'.

14. Layout

The markings made on the laid out cloth according to the pattern are called 'lay out'.

15. Lining

The layer of cloth used under the cloth of the garment is known as 'lining'. Lining is used in fine and delicate fabrics (silks) in woolen cloth (in coats) under rough fabrics and under transparent fabrics like organdy.

16. Inter lining

Any cloth used between the cloth of the garment and the lining cloth is known as 'interlining'. Example 'buckram'.

17. Balance mark

The different pieces of a garment are marked in order to keep a balance during stitching. These marks are known as 'balance marks'.

18. Turning

The section of cloth which is turned inside to finish the length of any garment is known as 'turning'. This can be let out to increase the length of the garment.

19. Turn up

Sometimes the turning is turned up onto the right side of the garment. This is known as 'turn-up'.

20. Finishing

The trimming of all extra thread after completion of a garment is known as 'finishing'.

21. Locking of seam

Securing the beginning and end of seam is known as 'locking of seam'.

22. Button stand

When buttons are fixed to a thick edge as in a coat, the button is not fixed not flat onto the edge but some length of thread is left between the button and the garment surface. This length of thread is known as a 'button stand'. It allows the two thick edges to close comfortably without tightening of the button.

23. Flap

The piece of cloth attached to cover the top of a pocket is called a 'flap'.

24. Velt

Velt is the piece of original cloth used to make the opening of a cut pocket.

25. Warp

The lengthwise threads in a fabric are called 'warp'.

26. Weft

The widthwise threads in a fabric are called 'weft'.

27. Paper pattern

After the drafting is made, it is transferred to a paper according to the actual measurements of the garment. This is known as 'paper pattern'.

28. Depth of syce

The depth of the armhole is called 'depth of syce'.

29. Arm hole

The opening for the arm is known as 'arm hole'. It is the place where the sleeve of the garment fits in.

30. Try

When the garment is made by tacking and tried on for size and fitting, it is called 'try'.

31. Damp cloth

While pressing woolen garments a soft moist cloth is placed over the garment and then pressed. This cloth is called 'damp cloth'.

32. Trimming

Any material used to decorate a garment like lace, beads, ribbons, etc. is know as 'trimming'.

33. Leg shape

The shape of the inner leg below the crotch is called 'leg shape'.

34. Placket

Any opening in a garment which has an overlap is called a 'placket'. Plackets usually have some means of closing like a zip, button with holes or hooks with eyes, etc.

35. Alteration

Changes made in a garment to remove fitting defects.

36. Selvedge

The lengthwise edge of a fabric is called 'selvedge'.

37. Stud

The upper portion of a press button is called 'stud'.

38. Tacking

To join two pieces of cloth with long, uneven stitches, preparatory to final stitching is called 'tacking'.

39. Sleeve head

The top round portion of a sleeve is called 'sleeve head'.

40. Renovation

To give a new look to an old garment is called 'renovation'.

41. Flair

The loose, round part of a garment is called 'flair', as in a skirt or sleeve.

42. Jetting

The piece of cloth used to cover the edge of a pocket in order to cover the lining is called 'jetting piece'.

43. Gorge

The roundness of a neckline is known as 'gorge'.

44. Iron speaking

The hissing sound made when a very hot iron comes in contact with water is known as 'iron speaking'.

3.7 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

You have learnt about some technical terms and the advantages of using them.

3.8 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Write short notes on the following:

   i) Lining and interlining

   ii) Laying

   iii) Slit